

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Parliament - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Parliament REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	ARTICLE 79 ARCHITECTURE: WHAT PARLIAMENT CONSTITUTIONALLY IS Article 79 constitutes Parliament as the President, Council of States
02	COMPOSITION, ELECTION, TERM AND SEAT CEILINGS Articles 80, 81 and 83 regulate House composition, representation,
03	REPRESENTATION, DELIMITATION AND THE SEAT-FREEZE BARGAIN Articles 81 and 82 operate with the 42nd, 84th and 87th Amendments
04	QUALIFICATIONS, DISQUALIFICATIONS AND VACANCIES Articles 84, 101, 102 and 103 separate qualification, vacancy and
05	LEADER OF OPPOSITION AND OPPOSITION ARCHITECTURE The 1977 Act defines the Leader of Opposition through recognition
06	SESSIONS, SITTINGS, ADJOURNMENT, PROROGATION AND DISSOLUTION Articles 83 and 85 distinguish duration, summoning, prorogation and
07	QUESTIONS, ZERO HOUR, DISCUSSIONS AND MOTIONS House rules and Article 75(3) connect information devices with the
08	PRESIDING OFFICERS: AUTHORITY, CONTINUITY AND NEUTRALITY Articles 89 to 97 govern election, tenure, removal, continuity and
09	PARLIAMENTARY PRIVILEGES AND THE SITA SOREN BOUNDARY Article 105 protects speech, votes and authorized publication subject
10	LEGISLATIVE PROCEDURE FOR AN ORDINARY BILL Articles 107 and 111 structure introduction, bicameral passage, return
11	ORDINARY, MONEY, FINANCIAL AND CONSTITUTION AMENDMENT BILLS Articles 109, 110, 117 and 368 create distinct procedures for fiscal and
12	JOINT SITTING, LEGISLATIVE DEADLOCK AND BILL LAPSE Article 108 supplies joint sitting for eligible deadlocks while
13	BUDGET, GRANTS AND THE CONSTITUTIONAL FUNDS Articles 112 to 116 and 266 to 267 regulate grants, appropriation and
14	PARLIAMENTARY CONTROL OF THE EXECUTIVE Article 75(3) anchors collective responsibility within a wider
15	PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEES: ARCHITECTURE AND EXACT CONTROLS Financial committees, DRSCs and ad hoc bodies divide audit,
16	RAJYA SABHA: EQUAL, UNEQUAL AND EXCLUSIVE POWERS Articles 109, 249, 312 and 368 create a graded rather than uniformly
17	ANTI-DEFECTION, WHIP AND THE INDIVIDUAL PARLIAMENTARIAN The Tenth Schedule regulates party exit and whip defiance, with
18	INDIAN PARLIAMENTARY GROUP, IPU AND CPA IPG is Indian National Group in the IPU and main India Branch of the
19	PARLIAMENTARY DECLINE: DIAGNOSIS, COUNTER-EVIDENCE AND REFORM Executive agenda control, wide whip, disruption, guideline and
20	LIVE UNIT: 106TH AMENDMENT, CENSUS 2027 AND DELIMITATION Article 154A requires published post-commencement census figures

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Polity 17 - Parliament - Complete Topic Package

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original MCQ loop - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Constitutional composition

Parliament under Article 79 consists of:

- A. President, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha B. Prime Minister, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha C. President and Lok Sabha only D. Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha only

Answer: A. [FACT] The President is an integral organ of Parliament though not a member of either House.

OM2. Rajya Sabha election

Which correctly describes election of elected Rajya Sabha members from States?

- A. Direct FPTP through territorial constituencies B. Proportional representation by single transferable vote through elected MLAs C. List proportional representation through all adults D. Nomination by Governors after Assembly consultation

Answer: B. [FACT] Elected MLAs form the electorate; the 2003 statutory change introduced open ballot.

OM3. Seat-freeze extension

Which amendment extended readjustment until publication of figures of the first census taken after 2026?

- A. 42nd Amendment B. 61st Amendment C. 84th Amendment D. 87th Amendment

Answer: C. [FACT] The 42nd began the freeze; the 84th extended it; the 87th changed the boundary-readjustment census basis to 2001.

OM4. Lok Sabha nomination

Which statement is correct?

- A. Anglo-Indian nomination was converted into Rajya Sabha nomination. B. Lok Sabha has twelve nominated members. C. The President may presently nominate two Anglo-Indians to Lok Sabha. D. The 104th Amendment ended the Anglo-Indian nomination provision for Lok Sabha.

Answer: D. [FACT] Present Lok Sabha composition has no nominated Anglo-Indian members.

OM5. Article 84

Which is a constitutional qualification for Parliament membership?

- A. Citizenship of India B. Prior legislative experience C. Graduation from a recognised university D. Residence for ten years in the represented State

Answer: A. [FACT] Citizenship, prescribed oath, minimum age and statutory qualifications form the gate.

OM6. Sitting-member disqualification

Who decides an Article 102(1) question concerning a sitting MP?

- A. Speaker acting alone B. President after obtaining the Election Commission's opinion C. Supreme Court in original jurisdiction D. Returning Officer

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 103 creates the President-ECI decision route.

OM7. Leader of Opposition

Which statement best reflects the Core control?

A. LoP is appointed by the President. B. LoP is a purely constitutional office named in Article 75. C. LoP is statutory under the 1977 Act; the Act itself prescribes no ten-percent threshold. D. The largest opposition leader automatically becomes LoP in all circumstances.

Answer: C. [FACT] Distinguish the statutory recognised office from the political leader of the largest opposition party.

OM8. Prorogation

Prorogation:

A. Causes every pending Bill to lapse. B. Is ordered by the Speaker. C. Ends the life of Lok Sabha. D. Ends a session through presidential action while pending Bills generally survive.

Answer: D. [FACT] Adjournment is by the chair; dissolution, not prorogation, ends Lok Sabha.

OM9. Starred question

A starred question ordinarily:

A. Receives an oral answer and permits supplementary questions. B. Cannot concern a ministry. C. Is identical to Zero Hour. D. Receives only a written answer.

Answer: A. [FACT] Oral follow-up makes starred questions the principal live cross-examination device.

OM10. No-confidence motion

Which is correct?

A. Its defeat dissolves Rajya Sabha. B. It belongs only to Lok Sabha and needs support of 50 members for admission. C. It must specify charges against each minister. D. It can be moved in either House.

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 75(3) ties collective responsibility to Lok Sabha; reasons need not be stated.

OM11. Speaker after dissolution

On dissolution of Lok Sabha, the Speaker:

A. Vacates immediately with all members. B. Continues for six months. C. Continues until immediately before the first sitting of the new Lok Sabha. D. Becomes a Rajya Sabha officer.

Answer: C. [FACT] Article 94 preserves institutional continuity.

OM12. Speaker's removal resolution

While a resolution for the Speaker's removal is considered:

A. The Speaker cannot enter the House. B. The Deputy Speaker cannot preside. C. The Speaker presides and uses only a casting vote. D. The Speaker does not preside, may vote in the first instance and has no casting vote.

Answer: D. [FACT] Article 96 removes the conflict in presiding, not the member's right to participate.

OM13. Sita Soren

The 2024 seven-judge ruling establishes that:

A. Legislative privilege does not immunise acceptance of a bribe for speech or vote. B. Only actual voting, not bribe acceptance, can complete bribery. C. Article 105 has been invalidated. D. All parliamentary speech may be criminally prosecuted.

Answer: A. [FACT] The offence is complete on acceptance; bona fide speech/vote immunity survives.

OM14. Ordinary Bill deadlock

Which is a recognised Article 108 trigger?

- A. States refuse to ratify an amendment. B. The second House rejects an ordinary Bill or the Houses finally disagree.
C. President returns a Bill. D. Rajya Sabha recommends changes to a Money Bill.

Answer: B. [FACT] Eligible deadlocks include rejection, final disagreement and specified delay; Money and amendment Bills are excluded.

OM15. Money Bill

Which condition is essential?

- A. A joint sitting resolves disagreement. B. Rajya Sabha must consent within fourteen days. C. It must contain only Article 110 matters and incidental provisions. D. It may include any policy matter if taxation is also present.

Answer: C. [FACT] "Only" is the classification firewall; Rajya Sabha recommendations are non-binding.

OM16. Financial Bill-II

Which statement is correct?

- A. It can originate only in Lok Sabha. B. Rajya Sabha has recommendation-only power. C. It is always a Money Bill. D. It may originate in either House, with presidential recommendation required before consideration.

Answer: D. [FACT] Article 117(3) differs from both Money Bill and Financial Bill-I.

OM17. Joint-sitting history

How many joint sittings had been held according to the controlled Core?

- A. Three B. Five C. One D. Four

Answer: A. [FACT] Dowry 1961, Banking Service 1978 and POTA 2002.

OM18. Bill lapse

Which Bill lapses on Lok Sabha dissolution?

- A. Bill for which joint sitting was notified B. Bill passed by Lok Sabha but pending in Rajya Sabha C. Bill passed by both Houses awaiting assent D. Bill pending in Rajya Sabha and never passed by Lok Sabha

Answer: B. [FACT] It carries the expired Lok Sabha's unfinished mandate.

OM19. Charged expenditure

Charged expenditure on the Consolidated Fund:

- A. Is voted by both Houses. B. Is neither discussed nor voted. C. May be discussed but is not submitted to vote. D. Is voted only by Rajya Sabha.

Answer: C. [FACT] The non-votable character protects specified constitutional expenditures while allowing discussion.

OM20. Token cut

A Token Cut Motion reduces a demand by:

- A. Ten per cent B. Re 1 C. The full disputed amount D. Rs 100

Answer: D. [FACT] Re 1 is Policy Cut; Token Cut ventilates a specific grievance.

OM21. Public Account

Which fund does not require parliamentary appropriation for withdrawal?

A. Public Account of India B. Consolidated Fund of India C. Contingency Fund after recoupment D. Every constitutional fund requires identical appropriation

Answer: A. [FACT] Public Account contains money held in trust; Consolidated Fund withdrawal requires appropriation.

OM22. PAC

Which correctly describes PAC?

A. 30 Lok Sabha members; prospective estimates scrutiny B. 22 members (15 LS + 7 RS); examines CAG reports; Opposition chair by convention C. 22 members; examines only private corporations D. 31 members; every ministry has a separate PAC

Answer: B. [FACT] PAC is retrospective audit scrutiny; ministers are barred.

OM23. Estimates Committee

Which is correct?

A. It decides whether expenditure was legally authorised after the fact. B. It is conventionally chaired by the Opposition. C. It has 30 Lok Sabha members and examines economy/efficiency in estimates. D. It has seven Rajya Sabha members.

Answer: C. [FACT] PAC handles post-expenditure CAG audit; Estimates is Lok Sabha-only and prospective.

OM24. DRSC composition

Each DRSC has:

A. 30 members: 20 LS + 10 RS B. 22 members: 15 LS + 7 RS C. 31 members: 20 LS + 11 RS D. 31 members: 21 LS + 10 RS

Answer: D. [FACT] There were 17 in 1993 and 24 from 2004; 16 are LS-serviced and 8 RS-serviced.

OM25. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee

Which is correct?

A. It has 30 members (20 LS + 10 RS) and examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation. B. It is the same institution as the NCSC. C. Ministers must constitute half its membership. D. It has only Lok Sabha members.

Answer: A. [FACT] It is a standing parliamentary committee; ministers are barred.

OM26. Rajya Sabha's exclusive powers

The controlled pair is:

A. Articles 75 and 113 B. Articles 249 and 312 C. Articles 110 and 123 D. Articles 108 and 111

Answer: B. [FACT] Rajya Sabha initiates national-interest State List legislation and creation of All-India Services.

OM27. Anti-defection merger

Which threshold supports the surviving merger exception?

A. Half of members present B. One-third of the House C. At least two-thirds of the legislature party D. Unanimous party membership

Answer: C. [FACT] The 91st Amendment deleted the former one-third split defence.

OM28. Nominated member under Tenth Schedule

Which statement is correct?

A. The rule is identical to that for an independent. B. A nominated member can never join a party. C. A nominated member may join at any time without consequence. D. A nominated member may join within six months; joining after that can disqualify.

Answer: D. [FACT] An independent is disqualified upon joining any party.

OM29. IPG

The Indian Parliamentary Group:

A. Is India's National Group in the IPU and main India Branch of the CPA. B. Is limited to Rajya Sabha members. C. Is a wing of the Ministry of External Affairs. D. Represents governments at the United Nations.

Answer: A. [FACT] IPG organises parliamentary exchange; IPU is global and CPA Commonwealth-specific.

OM30. 106th Amendment status

As of 28 August 2026:

A. One-third of current Lok Sabha seats are already reserved. B. It commenced on 16 April 2026, but the reservation remains non-operational pending the Article 334A sequence. C. The quota necessarily ends in 2041. D. The Act has not commenced.

Answer: B. [FACT] Commenced and operational are different registers; no end year should be derived.

OM31. Census trigger

What must occur immediately before delimitation can switch on the Article 334A reservation sequence?

A. Completion of houselisting alone B. Reference date of 1 March 2027 C. Publication of the relevant figures of the first post-commencement census D. Passage of an ordinary resolution

Answer: C. [FACT] Enumeration/reference dates are not publication dates.

OM32. 2026 delimitation package

Which statement is correct?

A. Lok Sabha's ceiling is now 850. B. The package created a binding precedent. C. Delimitation must now use the 2011 Census. D. The 131st Amendment Bill proposed 850 but was defeated for want of the Article 368 special majority.

Answer: D. [FACT] 298:230 cleared the total-membership limb but not two-thirds of 528 present and voting.

OM33. Money Bill judicial status

Which is the safest current formulation?

A. Article 110 says final, but narrow constitutional review remains and the *Rojer Mathew* larger issue has no visible final resolution as of 28 August 2026. B. *Puttaswamy* unanimously settled every Article 110 issue. C. Speaker certification is wholly immune from courts. D. *Rojer Mathew* finally invalidated all Money Bills.

Answer: A. [FACT]/[CURRENT] The formulation preserves textual finality, narrow review and pending-status caution.

OM34. Deputy Speaker

Which statement is correct?

A. The office automatically falls vacant on every adjournment. B. The House elects the Deputy Speaker, who has the Speaker's powers when presiding. C. The Deputy Speaker is appointed by the Speaker. D. The Constitution fixes a thirty-day election deadline.

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 93 says "as soon as may be" but supplies no numerical deadline.

OM35. Parliamentary reform

Which reform most directly improves clause-level legislative scrutiny?

A. Abolishing Rajya Sabha B. Treating every Bill as a Money Bill C. Default committee referral with reasoned urgency exceptions D. Expanding every whip to every vote

Answer: C. [ANALYSIS] It targets the point where evidence and legal text can be tested without destroying emergency flexibility.

OM36. MPLADS

Which statement follows the controlled routed demand?

A. The current annual amount may be quoted without checking. B. Its funds necessarily lapse at year-end. C. MPLADS is a constitutional entitlement. D. It is a scheme with non-lapsable funds; current rupee amount requires live official verification.

Answer: D. [FACT]/[LIMIT] Stable scheme characteristics can be stated; live amounts cannot be guessed.

Remedial MCQs - strict A -> B -> A -> D rotation

RM1. President and membership

Which correction is accurate?

A. The President is an integral part of Parliament but not a member of either House. B. Parliament excludes the President. C. The President votes in joint sittings. D. The President is a nominated Rajya Sabha member.

Answer: A. The Article 79 architecture distinguishes institutional membership from being an integral constitutional organ.

RM2. Session rule

The Constitution requires:

A. At least 100 Lok Sabha sitting days B. No more than six months between the relevant sittings of successive sessions C. Exactly three sessions every year D. A Winter Session every November

Answer: B. Budget/Monsoon/Winter are conventions; Article 85 supplies the six-month ceiling, not a sitting-day quota.

RM3. Prorogation trap

What ordinarily happens to a pending Bill on prorogation?

A. It lapses if introduced by a private member. B. It becomes an ordinance. C. It survives. D. It goes automatically to joint sitting.

Answer: C. Prorogation ends a session; dissolution creates the selective lapse rules.

RM4. Speaker removal

Which statement is correct?

A. Speaker must preside over the resolution. B. No advance notice is required. C. Removal uses a simple majority of members present and voting. D. Removal needs a majority of all the then members after fourteen days' notice.

Answer: D. This is an effective majority; Article 96 separately bars the Speaker from presiding.

RM5. Financial Bill-I trap

A Financial Bill-I:

A. Starts only in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation, but Rajya Sabha retains full legislative power. B. Cannot go to joint sitting. C. Is always subject to the fourteen-day recommendation rule. D. Contains only Article 110 matters.

Answer: A. The presence of other matters takes it outside the narrow Money Bill procedure.

RM6. Joint-sitting exclusion

Which pair has no joint-sitting route?

A. Government Bill and Private Member's Bill B. Money Bill and Constitution Amendment Bill C. Ordinary Bill and Financial Bill-I D. Ordinary Bill and Financial Bill-II

Answer: B. Money Bills have Article 109 procedure; amendments require separate Article 368 passage.

RM7. Committee-number trap

Which statement is correct?

A. Estimates Committee has 15 LS and 7 RS members. B. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee has 31 members. C. DRSCs were 17 in 1993 and 24 from 2004; each has 21 LS and 10 RS members. D. DRSCs were 24 from their introduction in 1993.

Answer: C. The standard distractors wrongly backdate 24 or swap the 21+10 composition.

RM8. Privilege trap

After *Sita Soren*:

A. Article 105 was repealed judicially. B. No speech in Parliament is protected. C. Members have immunity for a bribe if they later vote. D. Bribery lacks privilege immunity, while bona fide speech/vote protection remains.

Answer: D. The judgment targets the separate criminal bargain, not legislative freedom of debate.

RM9. Rajya Sabha status

Which statement is most accurate?

A. Rajya Sabha is weaker on money/confidence, equal in major legislative fields and exclusive under Articles 249/312. B. Rajya Sabha may remove the Union ministry. C. Rajya Sabha is inferior in every field. D. Rajya Sabha alone votes demands for grants.

Answer: A. A graded comparison is required; blanket equality or inferiority is wrong.

RM10. Women's reservation trap

Which is correct as of 28 August 2026?

A. The Act remains uncommenced. B. The Act commenced, but operational reservation awaits publication-linked delimitation. C. Its end date is conclusively 2041. D. Reservation automatically began with Census houselisting.

Answer: B. Enacted, commenced and operational are three separate registers.

RM11. 2026 Bill arithmetic

The 131st Amendment Bill failed because:

A. Rajya Sabha rejected it after Lok Sabha passage. B. It failed the total-membership-majority limb. C. It cleared a simple majority but failed two-thirds of members present and voting. D. It received fewer ayes than noes.

Answer: C. 298 exceeded half of 543 but not two-thirds of 528; it never reached Rajya Sabha.

RM12. Deputy Speaker status

Which statement is correct on the official Lok Sabha control checked 28 August 2026?

A. The Constitution requires election within thirty days. B. The Deputy Speaker's office is permanently abolished. C. The official page dates the vacancy from 2018. D. The office is vacant, and the official page dates the vacancy from May 2019.

Answer: D. Article 93 governs election by the House; the vacancy statement is a dated official control and must not be converted into a timeless constitutional rule.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Answer-writing architecture

Visual 39 - Mandatory answer spine

CLAIM
directly answer the directive
|
NAMED EVIDENCE
Article / case / committee / amendment / dated official event
|
ANALYSIS
explain mechanism, consequence or significance
|
QUALIFICATION
state counter-evidence, status limit or variation
|
VERDICT
graded answer to the exact question

Directive fidelity

Directive	Required operation	Common failure
Discuss	Explain major dimensions with balance	Mere list
Examine	Test the proposition using evidence	One-sided assertion
Evaluate	Apply criteria, strengths and weaknesses, then judge	Description without judgment
To what extent	Give a degree-based answer	Absolute yes/no
Highlight factors and areas	Separate causes from fields of effect	Mixing both
Elucidate	Clarify mechanism with evidence	Generic merits/demerits

Mark-scaled evidence load

Marks/words	Structure	Named evidence target
10 / 150	Thesis -> 2-3 mechanisms -> one qualification -> verdict	2-3 precise Articles/cases/committees
15 / 250	Thesis -> 4-5 dimensions -> counterpoint -> verdict	4-6 named units
20 / 250	Thesis -> architecture -> causes -> consequences -> counterevidence -> reform -> graded verdict	5-8 named units

Reusable answer spines

- **Executive accountability:** Article 75(3) -> questions/discussions -> motions -> budget -> committees -> whip/time limits -> degree-based verdict.
- **Rajya Sabha:** money/confidence subordination -> ordinary/amendment equality -> Articles 249/312 -> continuity/federal role -> supporting-not-subordinate verdict.
- **Speaker:** Articles 93-97 -> rule/Money Bill/defection powers -> British convention contrast -> judicial/structural limits -> reform.
- **Committees:** standing/ad hoc -> financial trio -> DRSCs -> usefulness -> advisory/referral weaknesses -> strengthen, not bypass.
- **Decline:** whip -> executive calendar -> guillotine/referral decline -> bypass routes -> counter-instruments -> reforms.
- **Money Bill:** Article 110 "only" -> Article 109 procedure -> Speaker certificate -> *Puttaswamy/Rojer Mathew* -> federal cost -> qualified pending-status verdict.

Solved directly routed Mains PYQs

Provenance rule: The seven 2018-2023 demands are routed by the audited Core owner. The 2024 GS-II Q3 wording is verified in the cross-owned Polity 11/16 packages. Neutral wording is used where exact UPSC wording has not been independently reproduced here.

PYQ-M1. 2018 GS-II Q4 - Usefulness of parliamentary committees, especially the Estimates Committee

Demand decoding

- "Discuss" requires functions, usefulness, limitations and a balanced conclusion.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** use three institutional units, not a catalogue of every committee.

Model answer

Claim: Parliamentary committees are indispensable "working rooms" of Parliament because they preserve detailed scrutiny when plenary time is scarce.

Named evidence: The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members**, excludes ministers and examines budget estimates for economy, efficiency and administrative improvement. It complements the **PAC**, which audits CAG findings after expenditure, and **CoPU**, which specialises in public undertakings. The **24 DRSCs**, each with 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha members, examine demands for grants, referred Bills and ministry reports.

Analysis: Small membership, evidence-taking, continuity and less theatrical party competition allow technical and often cross-party scrutiny. Estimates scrutiny is preventive: it asks whether public money can be spent better before audit identifies failure.

Qualification: Reports are advisory; attendance, research support and Bill referral vary. Estimates recommendations cannot themselves alter grants.

Verdict: Committees do not replace the House, but they make its financial and legislative control credible. Routine referral and stronger follow-up would increase their usefulness.

Examiner note: Exact Estimates-PAC-CoPU differentiation, DRSC evidence and one limitation make this complete rather than descriptive.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named committee units plus a qualified verdict.

Why this earns marks: Exact committee differentiation, causal usefulness and a bounded advisory-status verdict satisfy the directive.

How to improve this answer: If compressed, retain Estimates 30 LS-only, PAC-CAG, one DRSC function and the advisory/referral limit; drop the wider committee catalogue.

PYQ-M2. 2019 GS-II Q15 - Decline of the individual parliamentarian and debate quality

Demand decoding

- “Discuss” requires mechanisms causing decline, surviving opportunities and reforms.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** separate member autonomy, House time and scrutiny quality.

Model answer

Claim: The individual MP's law-making role has declined because party and executive institutions increasingly determine both the vote and the agenda.

Named evidence and analysis: First, the **Tenth Schedule** makes defiance of a party direction potentially disqualifying. This stabilises government but converts many legislative choices into party commands. Second, the executive controls most government business and drafting; limited sitting time, disruption and the **guillotine** can pass demands without discussion. Third, fewer or selective referrals to **DRSCs** remove the main site for clause-level, evidence-based scrutiny. Fourth, ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** Money Bill route can compress prior bicameral deliberation. Finally, the rarity of successful Private Members' Bills signals limited non-government law-making space.

Counter-evidence: MPs still use starred questions, Zero Hour, motions, committee reports, amendments and constituency knowledge. Rajya Sabha scrutiny and opposition-led PAC work can produce institutional effects even without defeating the government.

Qualification: Decline varies with majority size, coalition politics, committee referral and presiding-officer practice; it is not a constitutional disappearance of the MP.

Verdict: The parliamentarian has shifted from autonomous law-maker toward party-linked scrutiniser. Predictable sittings, default committee referral and a whip confined to confidence/core finance would restore deliberation without destabilising government.

Examiner note: The answer explains the causal chain and acknowledges surviving agency; it does not confuse low autonomy with legal powerlessness.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 5 mechanisms, 2 counter-instruments and 3 reforms.

Why this earns marks: The answer explains the whip-agenda-time causal chain, preserves surviving MP agency and closes with feasible reforms.

How to improve this answer: For 150 words, keep Tenth Schedule, executive agenda, one scrutiny loss and one reform; for 250 words retain counter-evidence and variation by majority size.

PYQ-M3. 2020 GS-II Q5 - “Once a Speaker, always a Speaker” and objectivity

Demand decoding

- Answer both parts: whether the convention operates in India and its implications for objectivity.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** one institutional contrast, three powers, one reform.

Model answer

Claim: The British convention that a Speaker severs party ties and is normally returned unopposed does not operate in India; therefore neutrality rests more on individual conduct than institutional insulation.

Named evidence: Under **Articles 93-97**, the Speaker controls procedure and discipline. The office also certifies a Money Bill under **Article 110**, presides over an **Article 108** joint sitting and decides Tenth Schedule petitions subject to *Kihoto Hollohan*. The Speaker retains party membership and ordinarily contests again on a party ticket.

Analysis: These high-stakes powers can affect bicameralism, government survival and member status. A party-linked career therefore creates a perception of bias even when a decision is legally defensible. Delayed defection rulings and disputed Money Bill certification intensify the concern.

Qualification: Article 94 continuity after dissolution, charged salary and House removal safeguards provide some independence; party origin does not prove actual partisanship.

Verdict: “Once a Speaker, always a Speaker” is aspirational, not Indian practice. Reasoned rulings, political detachment and independent defection adjudication would make objectivity structural.

Examiner note: Direct convention answer plus powers-mechanism-qualification sequence satisfies both limbs.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named powers and one balanced reform.

Why this earns marks: It answers both the comparative-convention and objectivity limbs through three high-stakes powers and a qualified institutional judgment.

How to improve this answer: Compress to Article 110, Tenth Schedule and party-linked career; improve further by separating perceived bias from proof of bias in one explicit sentence.

PYQ-M4. 2020 GS-II Q14 - Rajya Sabha as a supporting organ

Demand decoding

- "Highlight factors and areas" requires separate treatment of causes and fields of subordination.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** avoid the absolute claim that Rajya Sabha is inferior everywhere.

Model answer

Claim: Rajya Sabha is a supporting chamber in finance and confidence, but a co-equal or distinctive chamber in ordinary law, constitutional amendment and federal protection.

Areas of subordination: Under **Articles 109-110**, it can only recommend changes to a Money Bill within fourteen days. It cannot vote demands for grants, and **Article 75(3)** gives only Lok Sabha the confidence key. In an **Article 108** joint sitting, Lok Sabha's larger numbers usually prevail.

Factors: Direct election gives Lok Sabha stronger popular legitimacy; executive survival is tied to its majority; and disputed use of the Money Bill route can bypass the Upper House. Political disruption and limited referral can further weaken revision.

Counter-evidence: Rajya Sabha has equal power over ordinary Bills and **Article 368** amendments. As a permanent House it supplies continuity. Its two exclusive powers - **Article 249** State List legislation in the national interest and **Article 312** creation of All-India Services - make it a federal gatekeeper. It also shares committee scrutiny and national debate.

Qualification: State representation is population-weighted, not equal-per-State; its federal design is therefore weaker than a senate based on State equality.

Verdict: Rajya Sabha supports Lok Sabha without being subordinate to it. The label is accurate only where the Constitution deliberately prioritises popular control over money and government survival.

Examiner note: Separates "factors" from "areas" and gives a degree-based verdict with Articles 249/312.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 3 subordinate fields, 4 counterweights and one design caveat.

Why this earns marks: The graded equal-unequal-exclusive structure directly answers both factors and areas without reducing Rajya Sabha to a uniformly inferior chamber.

How to improve this answer: Under time pressure use a three-row power matrix, then add Articles 249/312 and the population-weighted federal caveat before the verdict.

PYQ-M5. 2021 GS-II Q4 - Extent of Parliament's executive accountability

Demand decoding

- "To what extent" demands a graded judgment, not a list of devices.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** instruments -> limits -> degree-based verdict.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament possesses a comprehensive accountability toolkit, but its effectiveness is conditional on time, information and party incentives.

Named evidence: Starred questions and supplementaries compel ministerial explanation; Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions expose policy failure. **Article 75(3)** enables Lok Sabha no-confidence control. **Articles 112-114** require budget presentation, voting of grants and appropriation. **PAC-CAG** audit and **DRSC** scrutiny extend control

beyond the floor.

Analysis: These instruments cover the full administrative cycle - information, authorisation, ongoing criticism, financial audit and ultimate removal.

Qualification: A secure majority and the Tenth Schedule make government defeat unlikely. Disruptions, the guillotine, limited sitting days, selective committee referral and ordinances can weaken scrutiny.

Verdict: Accountability is constitutionally strong but behaviourally uneven: Parliament usually extracts information and audit, yet only exceptionally threatens executive survival. Protected scrutiny time and stronger committees would narrow the gap.

Examiner note: "Extent" is answered explicitly by distinguishing routine oversight from survival control.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 evidence families and 4 limitations.

Why this earns marks: A clear extent judgment distinguishes routine information/audit control from the exceptional survival sanction.

How to improve this answer: Retain Article 75(3), one financial-control chain, one committee and two operating limits; do not spend words cataloguing every motion.

PYQ-M6. 2021 GS-II Q15 - Working of DRSCs in enforcing executive control

Demand decoding

- "Evaluate" requires criteria: design, performance, weaknesses and final assessment.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** exact composition is essential.

Model answer

Claim: DRSCs are Parliament's most capable instrument of continuous ministry-wise oversight, but they enforce control through information and persuasion rather than binding command.

Named evidence: Introduced as **17 committees in 1993** and restructured to **24 from 2004**, each now has **31 members - 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha**; sixteen are Lok Sabha-secretariat serviced and eight Rajya Sabha-secretariat serviced. Ministers are barred. They examine demands for grants, referred Bills, annual reports and long-term policy.

Analysis: Their smaller forum permits evidence-taking, clause scrutiny, technical learning and cross-party consensus away from floor grandstanding. Demand-for-grants reports connect policy priorities with spending; Bill reports improve legal design; action-taken reports sustain follow-up.

Weaknesses: Referral is not automatic, recommendations are non-binding, terms are only one year, attendance and research support can be weak, and the government may provide delayed or formalistic responses. Major Bills passed without referral show that effectiveness depends on executive and presiding-officer choices.

Qualification: Non-binding status is not uselessness: reasoned reports shape debate, media and later policy, while final law and supply must remain with the House.

Verdict: DRSCs work effectively when used, but are under-used. Default referral, longer specialisation, expert staff and public reasons for bypass would convert potential into systematic control.

Examiner note: Exact 1993/2004 and 21+10 controls, functions and enforceability distinction produce an evaluative answer.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 235-250 words; 4 functions, 5 weaknesses and 4 reforms.

Why this earns marks: Exact 17-to-24 chronology, 21+10 composition, functions and non-binding influence provide evaluative rather than descriptive depth.

How to improve this answer: If shortening, preserve composition, demands/Bill scrutiny, optional referral and one reform; remove generic praise before removing institutional evidence.

PYQ-M7. 2023 GS-II Q16 - Committee structure and role of financial committees

Demand decoding

- “Explain the structure” requires classification before evaluating the financial arm.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** use exact committee compositions.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament's committee system combines permanent subject/House oversight with task-specific inquiry; its financial committees operationalise the constitutional power of the purse.

Structure: **Standing committees** include financial committees, 24 DRSCs, House-management committees and oversight bodies such as Subordinate Legislation, Privileges, Ethics, Government Assurances and Welfare of SCs/STs. **Ad hoc committees** include Select/Joint Committees on Bills and JPCs formed for a specified inquiry.

Named financial evidence: The **PAC** has **22 members (15 LS + 7 RS)**, is conventionally chaired by the Opposition and examines CAG reports after expenditure. The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members only** and seeks economy and administrative improvement before or during expenditure planning. **CoPU** has **22 members (15+7)** and specialises in public undertakings. Ministers are barred from all three.

Analysis: Estimates supplies prospective efficiency scrutiny, PAC retrospective legality/regularity scrutiny and CoPU institution-specific commercial accountability. DRSC examination of demands bridges these stages.

Qualification: Reports are advisory, PAC ordinarily avoids questioning policy itself and referral/follow-up may be weak.

Verdict: The structure substitutes depth for scarce floor time; its financial arm closes the authorisation-audit loop but needs stronger research and action-taken enforcement.

Examiner note: Begins with the required architecture, then explains rather than merely names each financial committee.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; classification plus exact 22/30/22 evidence.

Why this earns marks: Classification precedes the exact financial trio, and prospective, retrospective and undertaking-specific roles are analytically separated.

How to improve this answer: Use a standing-versus-ad-hoc opening, then PAC 15+7, Estimates 30 LS-only and CoPU 15+7; end with advisory-status and follow-up limits.

PYQ-M8. 2024 GS-II Q3 - Cabinet growth and marginalisation of parliamentary supremacy

Demand decoding

- “Elucidate” requires a mechanism showing how cabinet growth affects Parliament.
- “Parliamentary supremacy” must mean effective control/deliberation, not UK-style legal sovereignty.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** three mechanisms, correctives and qualified verdict.

Model answer

Claim: The cabinet remains responsible to Lok Sabha under **Article 75(3)**, yet fusion of executive and legislature can let a disciplined cabinet majority dominate the institution meant to control it.

Named evidence and analysis: The Tenth Schedule whip reduces independent voting; the government controls most Bills and House time; guillotining demands, selective DRSC referral and compressed debate weaken scrutiny. Ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** route can reduce prior legislative and bicameral examination. PMO-centred coordination may add prime-ministerial dominance over cabinet dominance.

Qualification: Parliament still authorises supply, may remove the ministry, asks questions and uses PAC-CAG/DRSC scrutiny. Courts enforce constitutional limits and elections renew responsibility.

Verdict: Cabinet growth has marginalised Parliament's deliberative and control functions, not transferred constitutional sovereignty. Predictable sittings, routine committee scrutiny and narrower whip use can restore responsible fusion.

Examiner note: It clarifies the proposition, proves the mechanism and avoids the sovereignty trap.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 mechanisms, 3 correctives and one reform verdict.

Why this earns marks: The answer links cabinet growth to agenda, whip and time control while retaining constitutional counterweights and a degree-based conclusion.

How to improve this answer: For 150 words, keep Article 75(3), agenda control, whip, committee/Question Hour counterweight and one activation reform; avoid repeating the word dominance.

Routed Parliament Prelims demand laboratory

Answer-key provenance: For 2018-2023, official keys are not held locally. For 2024-2025, official Set-A keys are held locally but no option letter is reproduced or inferred here. For 2026, the locally held Set-A keys are provisional and no option letter is reproduced or inferred. Each entry therefore gives the doctrinal solution and elimination logic, not an invented key.

2018-2023 routed demands: 11

Year/Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2018 Q1	First Lok Sabha opposition/LoP history	LoP is a statutory office under the 1977 Act; the Act prescribes no ten-percent threshold and leaves recognition to the presiding officer. Distinguish statutory text, recognition practice and largest opposition-party leadership.	Official key unavailable locally; do not invent first-party identity without exact source.
2018 Q20	Committee scrutinising delegated legislation	Committee on Subordinate Legislation examines whether delegated powers are properly exercised.	Not PAC, Estimates or Government Assurances.
2018 Q31	Money Bill definition/procedure	Article 110 “only” test; Lok Sabha origin; President recommendation; Speaker certificate; Rajya Sabha recommendations within 14 days; no joint sitting.	Official key unavailable locally; resolve each statement doctrinally.
2019 Q49	Parliament Disqualification Act/office of profit	Articles 102/103 plus Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959; President decides a sitting-member question after ECI opinion.	Exemption is office-specific, not a general immunity.
2019 Q69	Committees reviewing independent regulators	No single general “regulators committee”; relevant DRSC scrutinises the regulator with its parent ministry and subject field.	Committee jurisdiction follows ministry/subject allocation.
2020 Q2	Rajya Sabha powers equal to Lok Sabha	Equal on ordinary Bills, constitutional amendments and specified elections; unequal on Money Bills, demands and confidence; RS alone initiates Articles 249/312.	Avoid absolute equal/unequal statements.
2020 Q3	MPLADS inspection/carry-forward	MPLADS is a scheme; funds are non-lapsable and carry forward; utilisation is monitored/inspected under the scheme framework.	No current per-MP rupee amount is quoted without live official verification.
2020 Q20	Sessions, summoning and minimum sittings	President summons under Article 85; gap between sessions cannot exceed six months; no constitutional minimum sitting-day count.	Three named sessions are convention, not constitutional compulsion.
2022 Q15	Exclusive Lok Sabha powers	Money Bill origin/certification route, voting demands and holding confidence key are Lok Sabha domains; distinguish from shared legislative powers.	RS has separate Articles 249/312 powers.

Year/Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2022 Q20	Deputy Speaker election and powers	House elects under Article 93; when presiding, Deputy has Speaker's powers and casting vote; answerable to House, not Speaker; no constitutional deadline.	Do not assume a current vacancy without verification.
2023 Q37	Finance Bill and Money Bill procedure	Money Bill is the narrow Article 110 subset. Financial Bill-I starts in LS on recommendation but RS has full power; Financial Bill-II may start in either House and recommendation is needed before consideration.	"All Money Bills are Financial Bills, not vice versa."

2024-2025 routed demands: 7

Year/Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2024 Q68	Article 109/Money Bill and Rajya Sabha	RS cannot reject/amend; it recommends within 14 days; LS may reject recommendations; no return means deemed passage in LS form.	Official Set-A key exists locally; no option letter recorded here.
2024 Q80	Lok Sabha Ethics Committee	Examines unethical conduct of members; distinct from Privileges Committee, which addresses privilege/contempt.	Do not merge ethical misconduct and institutional privilege.
2024 Q81	Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam	106th Amendment: Arts 330A/332A/334A; enacted 2023, commenced 16 Apr 2026, reservation not operational pending publication -> delimitation sequence.	Official key exists; current status updated beyond exam date. No 2041 calculation.
2024 Q93	Speaker during removal resolution	Article 96: Speaker does not preside; may speak and vote in first instance, but no casting vote in that proceeding.	Removal requires effective majority and 14 days' notice.
2024 Q94	Bill lapse on dissolution	Lapses if pending in LS or passed LS/pending RS; survives if pending only in RS, awaiting assent, returned, or joint sitting notified.	Apply status, not a blanket rule.
2024 Q95	Prorogation/dissolution	Both are President's acts under Article 85; prorogation ends session and Bills survive; dissolution ends LS life; adjournment is chair's act.	RS is never dissolved.
2025 Q87	Speaker after dissolution/party resignation	Speaker continues until immediately before new House first sitting; Indian Speaker need not resign party membership.	Official Set-A key exists; no option letter recorded here.

2026 routed demands: 2

Year/Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2026 Q58	Starred, unstarred and supplementary questions	Starred: oral and supplementary allowed; unstarred: written and no supplementaries; supplementary is follow-up to oral answer; short-notice is a distinct urgent oral category.	Local Set-A key is provisional; no option letter recorded or inferred.
2026 Q59	Welfare of SCs/STs Committee	30 members = 20 LS + 10 RS; one-year term; chair appointed by Speaker; ministers barred; examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation.	Parliamentary committee, not the constitutional Commissions. Provisional-key caution applies.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. Explain how the constitutional design of parliamentary sessions both enables and limits executive accountability. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding: “Explain how” requires a mechanism, not merely definitions. Cover summoning rule, devices and the weak sitting-day floor.

Model solution

Claim: Session design keeps the executive periodically answerable but leaves the intensity of accountability to political control of the calendar.

Named evidence: **Article 85** prevents more than six months between sessions, ensuring at least two annual opportunities for scrutiny. Within sittings, starred questions, supplementaries, Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions demand explanation; **Article 75(3)** allows Lok Sabha to test confidence.

Analysis: Periodic summoning prevents indefinite executive rule without Parliament, while oral questions and motions convert presence into public responsibility.

Qualification: The Constitution fixes no minimum sitting days and does not mandate three named sessions. Executive influence over summoning, disruption and loss of Question Hour may satisfy Article 85 while weakening real scrutiny.

Verdict: The design guarantees recurrence, not adequacy. A predictable calendar and protected accountability time would convert the six-month floor into effective control.

Examiner comment: Strong because Article 85 is linked to actual devices and its design limitation, rather than treated as a calendar fact.

Why this earns marks: Direct thesis; two Articles; mechanism; qualification; feasible reform within 150-word scale.

How to improve this answer: If space is tight, retain Article 85, two live accountability devices and the no-minimum-sitting-days qualification; state the reform as protected scrutiny time.

M2. Legislative privilege is a functional immunity, not a personal impunity. Discuss with reference to *Sita Soren*. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding: Define function, apply the case and preserve the surviving immunity.

Model solution

Claim: Article 105 protects fearless legislative functioning, not private criminal bargains.

Named evidence: It immunises proceedings for speech and vote in Parliament and protects authorised parliamentary publication. Yet in ***Sita Soren v. Union of India (2024)*** a unanimous seven-judge Bench overruled *P.V. Narasimha Rao* and held that accepting a bribe for a speech or vote attracts no Article 105/194 immunity; bribery is complete on acceptance.

Analysis: The functional-nexus test explains the distinction: debate and voting require autonomy from external litigation, whereas a bribe subverts rather than enables that function.

Qualification: The judgment did not expose bona fide speeches or votes to ordinary suits. Nor does judicial review authorise courts to manage routine House procedure.

Verdict: Privilege remains a shield for institutional independence, but *Sita Soren* correctly denies its conversion into a personal criminal safe harbour.

Examiner comment: Uses exact case proposition and avoids the frequent overstatement that all speech immunity has disappeared.

Why this earns marks: Definition, Article, overruled precedent, functional analysis and precise qualification.

How to improve this answer: Keep the functional-nexus test, the overruled precedent and the acceptance-completes-bribery rule; do not imply that ordinary speech immunity disappeared.

M3. The Money Bill procedure is necessary for popular control of finance but vulnerable to bicameral bypass. Critically examine. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: "Critically examine" requires the rationale, misuse risk, case law and a bounded verdict.

Model solution

Claim: Articles 109-110 legitimately privilege the directly elected Lok Sabha in narrowly fiscal legislation, but overbroad certification can convert financial primacy into general legislative supremacy.

Named evidence: A Money Bill must contain **only** Article 110(1)(a)-(g) matters and incidental provisions. It begins in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation; Rajya Sabha may only recommend within fourteen days, and no joint sitting exists. The Speaker certifies it, with Article 110 calling the decision final.

Analysis: This design protects supply and taxation from Upper-House obstruction and aligns financial responsibility with the House that can dismiss the ministry. However, classification also removes Rajya Sabha's amendment veto. Adding substantial non-fiscal provisions therefore harms bicameralism and federal revision.

Judicial evidence: *Puttaswamy (Aadhaar)*, 2018 upheld the Aadhaar route by 4:1; *Rojer Mathew* (2019) doubted the reasoning and referred the larger question to seven judges.

Qualification: Textual finality is not ordinary merits appeal, yet narrow constitutional review for illegality/misuse remains. As of 28 August 2026 no visible final larger-Bench resolution was located.

Verdict: Popular financial control requires the special procedure, but constitutional fidelity requires strict enforcement of "only", reasoned certification and narrow review.

Examiner comment: Balances democratic rationale and federal cost, uses both leading cases and preserves current-status caution.

Why this earns marks: Article -> mechanism -> consequence -> cases -> qualification -> reform verdict.

How to improve this answer: Use a two-column rationale-versus-bypass frame; quote Article 110 only, preserve the pending-status date and avoid presenting review as a merits appeal.

M4. Parliament's power of the purse is exercised through a chain, not a single budget vote. Analyse. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Build the complete authorisation-to-audit cycle and identify weak links.

Model solution

Claim: Financial control is a sequence of disclosure, deliberation, authorisation, expenditure and audit rather than one annual approval.

Named evidence and analysis: **Article 112** requires the Annual Financial Statement and distinguishes charged from voted expenditure. Under **Article 113**, Lok Sabha alone votes demands for grants, using Policy, Economy and Token Cut Motions. DRSCs examine ministry demands before voting, though the **guillotine** may pass undiscussed demands. **Article 114** then requires an Appropriation Act before withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund, while the Finance Bill enacts taxation. **Articles 115-116** provide supplementary, additional, excess grants, vote on account, vote of credit and exceptional grants. After spending, the **CAG** audits and the **PAC** examines reports; excess expenditure is regularised only after this post-facto scrutiny.

Qualification: Rajya Sabha discusses but does not vote demands. Charged expenditure is discussed but not voted. Public Account withdrawal is outside appropriation. Majority discipline makes cut-motion success rare, and PAC review is retrospective.

Verdict: The chain is constitutionally comprehensive but only as strong as DRSC time, grant debate and audit follow-up. Protecting these stages matters more than ritual budget passage.

Examiner comment: The answer maps the entire cycle and differentiates charged expenditure, Public Account and Rajya Sabha's role.

Why this earns marks: Six named constitutional/institutional units linked analytically rather than listed.

How to improve this answer: Draw the authorisation-to-audit chain first, then add charged expenditure and Public Account as the two highest-value distinctions; omit minor grant taxonomy if necessary.

M5. Delimitation after the population freeze is simultaneously a democratic-equality and a federal-fairness problem. Examine with reference to the women's reservation trigger. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Examine both normative claims, then integrate Article 334A and current controls.

Model solution

Claim: Restoring population-proportional representation answers malapportionment but may penalise States that reduced fertility, making delimitation a federal bargain rather than a cartographic exercise.

Named evidence: Article 81(2)(a) links State seats to population. The **42nd Amendment** froze allocation on 1971 figures; the **84th Amendment** extended readjustment until publication of the first post-2026 census figures; the **87th** enabled 2001-based boundary readjustment. Because Rajya Sabha is population-weighted rather than equal-per-State, low-growth States lack a US-Senate-type counterweight.

Women's-reservation link: The **106th Amendment** inserted Articles 330A, 332A and 334A. It commenced on **16 April 2026**, but Article 334A requires publication of relevant first post-commencement census figures and delimitation before reservation operates. Census 2027 is the trigger census, yet publication and delimitation dates are unknown.

Counterpoint: Permanent under-representation of populous citizens is itself a democratic deficit; the freeze cannot substitute forever for representation.

Qualification: The defeated 131st Amendment Bill's 850 ceiling and 2011 basis are not law. No State or women's-seat projection is valid.

Verdict: Reform must reconcile vote equality with demographic-performance fairness, possibly through negotiated House design, without forecasting an outcome the Constitution has not yet produced.

Examiner comment: Integrates static freeze law, federal theory and the exact commenced-but-not-operational sequence.

Why this earns marks: Balanced normative analysis with Articles, amendments, current trigger and explicit risk controls.

How to improve this answer: Separate democratic equality, federal fairness and Article 334A into three paragraphs; never turn the defeated 850-seat proposal or an unknown publication date into law.

M6. "Parliament is strong in constitutional instruments but weak in their political use." Critically examine and propose reforms. (20 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Test both halves, cover the full accountability architecture and rank reforms.

Model solution

Claim: Parliament retains formidable powers over law, supply and executive survival, yet majority discipline and scarcity of scrutiny time often convert control into formal ratification.

Strength in instruments: Article 75(3) permits no-confidence removal; questions, motions and debates force explanation. Articles 112-114 require financial disclosure, grant voting and appropriation. Ordinary Bills need bicameral consent; DRSCs provide detailed ministry scrutiny; PAC-CAG review closes the audit loop. Rajya Sabha adds continuity and Articles 249/312.

Weakness in use: The Tenth Schedule discourages independent voting; government controls most business; disruption reduces Question Hour; the guillotine passes demands without debate; Bill referral is optional; ordinances and contested Money Bill routing compress scrutiny. Speaker-linked defection and certification powers create neutrality concerns.

Counter-evidence: Committee consensus, opposition-led PAC work, judicial review and public debate can alter policy even when the government wins every vote. Weakness varies with coalition arithmetic and institutional leadership.

Reform: create a predictable sitting calendar; protect questions and opposition time; make committee referral the default with reasoned urgency exceptions; strengthen research/action-taken review; narrow the whip to confidence/core supply; require timely, reasoned presiding-officer decisions.

Verdict: The constitutional hardware remains sound; political incentives and procedural time are the failing software. Reform should activate existing accountability before inventing new devices.

Examiner comment: Covers instruments, causal limits, counterevidence and a prioritised reform package within the directive.

Why this earns marks: Eight named evidence units and a memorable but qualified hardware/software verdict.

How to improve this answer: Rank reforms by the diagnosed cause: time, information, referral and whip. In a shorter answer retain four instruments, four constraints and three matched remedies.

M7. Evaluate whether Rajya Sabha and parliamentary committees together can compensate for executive dominance of Lok Sabha. (20 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Evaluate two institutions jointly, specify what they can and cannot compensate for, and give a degree-based judgment.

Model solution

Claim: Rajya Sabha and committees can improve revision, information and financial audit, but cannot fully neutralise a disciplined executive majority controlling confidence, supply and House time.

Rajya Sabha contribution: It is equal on ordinary and constitutional amendment Bills, permanent, committee-integrated and capable of federal debate. **Articles 249 and 312** give it exclusive federal initiative. A government lacking an Upper-House majority must negotiate on non-Money legislation.

Committee contribution: The **24 DRSCs (21 LS + 10 RS each)** scrutinise demands, referred Bills and reports; **PAC (15+7)** connects CAG audit to parliamentary accountability; Estimates and CoPU add prospective and undertaking-specific scrutiny. Smaller forums encourage expertise and cross-party consensus.

Limits: Article 109 reduces Rajya Sabha to recommendations on Money Bills; it cannot vote demands or remove the ministry under Article 75(3). Joint-sitting numbers favour Lok Sabha. Committee reports are advisory, Bill referral varies and the executive can control information and follow-up. Overbroad Money Bill use may bypass both Upper-House veto and ordinary committee pressure.

Qualification: Influence is not measured only by government defeat; reports, delay, amendment and public reasons can improve law.

Verdict: Together they are strong compensating correctives but not a counter-government. Strict Article 110 classification, default referral, research capacity and protected scrutiny time are needed for meaningful balance.

Examiner comment: Integrates bicameral and committee mechanisms and defines compensation by scrutiny quality rather than vote defeat alone.

Why this earns marks: Joint institutional evaluation, exact committee evidence, structural limits and reform-linked verdict.

How to improve this answer: Evaluate compensation by revision, information and audit rather than government defeat; preserve Money Bill, confidence and non-binding-report limits in the final paragraph.